

INTERNATIONAL MARKETING

TEAM CASE ANALYSIS

Fair & Lovely: Advertising, Cultural Significance, and Controversy

Sumeet Telgote

Thompson Rivers University

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1 Team Case Analysis: Fair & Lovely

Learning Team assignment (9%) — a case analysis of HUL's Fair & Lovely skin-cream brand, examining its advertising, cultural significance, and the controversy surrounding it, with recommendations for ethical and culturally sensitive marketing. Co-authored with Team 5: Ema Palkovicova, Piya Thakkar, Shantanu Inamati, Parth Gulati, and Divij Chhowala.



Slide 1 — Title slide — Team 5 case analysis



Slide 2 — Contents



Slide 3 — Case background — HUL's Fair & Lovely, launched 1975

Case background

- Fair and lovely was launched by HUL in 1975
- It has a presence in South-east Asian countries
- The cream's main active ingredient is niacinamide, a melanin suppressor
- It had a 90% share in Indian market at a point when its only competitor had just 10% share.
- When the competitor's market share began to increase, Fair and Lovely advertised the then controversial advertisements that made Fair and Lovely change their marketing strategy completely.



Slide 4 — Case analysis — framework (part 1)

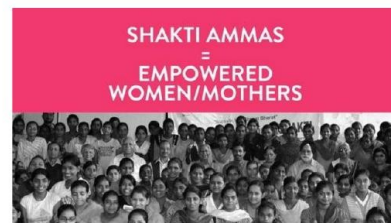
Case analysis

- Introduction
- Skin Comparison (West vs Asia)
- Advertising
- Cultural Significance
- Societal pressures
- Criticism



Slide 5 — Case analysis — framework (part 2)

- Dermatologist Insights
- Controversy
- Corporate response
- Persistent Demand
- Market Expansion
- Consumer Testimonials/Perspectives



Slide 6 — Case analysis — dermatologist insights, controversy, and market expansion

Recommendations

- Ethical Advertising Practices
- Promotion of Equality
- Market Research and Consumer Sentiments
- Cultural Sensitivity in Advertising



Slide 7 — Recommendations — ethical advertising and cultural sensitivity

Implications

- Market Entry Strategy
- Cultural Nuances
- Brand Management
- Ethical Consideration
- Corporate Social Responsibility
- Crisis Management
- Adapting Marketing Strategies
- Segmentation and Targeting
- Regulatory Compliance
- Cultural Sensitivity



Slide 8 — Implications — market entry, brand management, and regulatory compliance

Responses to discussion questions

1. Is it ethical to sell a product that is, at best, only mildly effective?
2. Is it ethical to exploit cultural norms and values to promote a product?
3. Is the advertising of Fair & Lovely demeaning to women, or is it promoting the fairness cream in a way not too dissimilar from how most cosmetics are promoted?
4. Propose a promotion/marketing program that will counter all the arguments and charges against Fair & Lovely and be an effective program.
5. In light of AIDWA's charges, how would you suggest Fair & Lovely promote its product?



Slide 9 — Responses to discussion questions

Conclusion

- Ethical Consideration
- Cultural Significance for Fair Skin (India & other Asian countries)
- Marketing Strategy for Fair & Lovely
- Advertisement Impact
- Response to Criticism
- Future Recommendation



Slide 10 — Conclusion

THANK YOU FOR ATTENTION :)

Slide 11 — Closing slide